

SOC122

Introduction to the Social Sciences

Reading across ways of knowing

A short, friendly map to your course companion site, what it is, where everything lives, and how to make it work for you.

YOUR COURSE SITE

SOC122 Companion Website

This instructor-created companion website supports weekly learning in SOC122. Open it from Blackboard or use the public address in this guide.

START HERE

Your companion site, not another inbox

This instructor-created companion website supports weekly learning in SOC122. It gathers weekly learning pathways, assigned readings, key concepts, experiences, and study supports in one place. Blackboard remains the official Seneca course platform for announcements, assignment submission, grades, discussions, course records, and required administrative functions.

✓ What it is

- Your weekly learning pathway, in working order
- Every reading, concept, and self-check in one spot
- A companion that sits beside Blackboard

✗ What it is not

- Not a replacement for Blackboard
- Not where announcements, submissions, discussions, grades, or course records live
- Not a place that collects student submissions or stores grades

Use it alongside Blackboard

This site does not require an account, does not collect student submissions, does not store grades, and does not send personal student information to the instructor, Seneca, or any server. The optional first name, notes, and check answers stay in this browser unless you remove or export them. External media players may be subject to the privacy practices of the host platform.

Course readings and media are linked for educational use. Copyright remains with the original creators and publishers. Students should access readings through the provided links, Seneca library access, or Blackboard where applicable. Students who experience barriers using the site should use Blackboard and contact the instructor so access can be supported.

START HERE

Open How This Site Works first

It is the first item in the course menu because it explains what this companion site does, what still belongs in Blackboard, what saves only in your browser, and how to clear saved work on a shared device.

After that short orientation, open Home for the weekly journey. The instructional manuals stay in Site Support whenever you need more detail.

THE WHOLE SITE, AT A GLANCE

The menu is the map

How This Site Works comes first, before Home, so students meet the site boundaries, privacy controls, accessibility supports, and reset option before beginning the course journey. The rest of the menu is grouped by the work students are trying to do. Home and Calendar orient the term; Weekly Experiences and other immersive spaces hold the teaching environments; source tools support evidence work; assignment and career tools support application; and Site Support keeps the instructional manuals and Report a Problem control.

The sample cards below explain the most-used doors. The live menu is always the complete and current navigation.

SOC122 Companion, navigation	
How This Site Works Start here: purpose, Blackboard boundaries, privacy, accessibility, saved work, and reset controls	
Home The course journey, week by week	Readings and Media Every assigned source, as a card
Compare Sources Hold up to three readings side by side	Source Practice Turn any reading into practice questions
Glossary Every key term, with its source	Concept Flashcards Retrieval practice, never scored
Weekly Experiences Every week's immersive teaching experience, in one hub	Cultural Lab and Course Synthesis Compare named contexts, then build a bounded synthesis

HOME

The course as a journey

Home lays the course out week by week. Each station shows the week's title and its **guiding question**, the one question worth carrying through everything you read that week.

- 1 Click any week station to open that week's page.
- 2 Coming back later? The site remembers where you were on this device and offers to pick up where you left off.

SOC122 Companion

ORIENT

- How This Site Works
- Home**
- Course Pathways
- Calendar and Due Dates

Personalize your route
 The required sources, outcomes, assessments, and grading stay the same.

YOUR PROGRAM

LEARNING EMPHASIS

COMING UP
 Open calendar

Live class (September 11): Week 1 live class Course orientation and shared start

Assignment released (September 11): Personal Cartography

SOC122 · Introduction to the Social Sciences · FALL 2026

Public life in Toronto
 Photo by Dillan Payne, Taste of Lawrence, 2020; CC BY-SA 4.0

HOME · THE COURSE JOURNEY, EACH WEEK WITH ITS GUIDING QUESTION

See the course through your program

The two controls on Home do different work. **Your program** changes the concrete field world: concept and key-term examples, the weekly field inquiry, case study, activity purpose, questions, reflection, and the full Career Choices route. **Learning emphasis** changes the intellectual route through every week: Western social science foregrounds the discipline's institutions, methods, archives, and classifications; Two-Eyed Seeing keeps Indigenous and Western knowledge systems whole and in accountable relation; Indigenous scholarship enters through the week's named scholar, Nation, community, place, and source. The hero and spotlight images, full spotlight explanation, reading order, key concept work, key term work, activity framing, experience, and reflection question all change with that emphasis. If you choose a program, the spotlight also adds a program-specific example and evidence boundary.

- 1 On Home, open **Your program**. Pick your exact Seneca program, an area of study, or the general route. The course does not guess your identity from your program.
- 2 Choose a **Learning emphasis**. Move between all three routes whenever you want to test what each foregrounds, what evidence it asks you to notice, and what boundary it keeps visible.
- 3 Open a week and look for **Learning emphasis**, the changing **spotlight**, and **For your program**. These are substantive routes through the shared course material, not labels added to the same paragraph.
- 4 For the deeper write-up, open **Career Choices** from the menu. It gives you three clear sections: program context, how SOC122 connects to that field, and how to use the social lens with care.
- 5 Change either control as often as you need. The site remembers the choice only in this browser.

A lens, not a different course

Every student works from the same required readings, learning outcomes, assessments, deadlines, and grading standard. Personalization changes the examples, evidence route, questions, images, and reasoning work. It does not assign a culture to you, substitute an optional context for assigned evidence, or create an easier version of the course.

COMPARE, THEN TEST YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Cultural Lab and Reflection Wings

Cultural Comparison Lab

Open it from **Immersive Rooms**. Choose a week and up to three named contexts. The lab changes its questions with the week and gives each context its own object of study, evidence base, and warning against conflation. Race, religion, nationality, language, region, and culture are never treated as interchangeable. The lab helps you build a comparison; it does not write the conclusion. Use **Reset comparison** whenever you want to begin again.

Reflection Wings

There is no Reflection Wing button on Home or in the menu. After you have explored enough of the course, the site may invite you to take one. You can accept or return to the classroom. Later invitations use harder questions, and the form varies so the experience is not identical each time. The feedback report is private, detailed practice worth no course marks. It uses rubric language to diagnose concepts, evidence, comparison, attribution, institutions, transfer, and synthesis, but it cannot grade the personal and original work required in a submitted assessment.

Anatomy of a week

Every week page runs in the order the week is meant to run. Work it top to bottom.

Study Guide. Before the Knowledge Check, each teaching week carries a rehearsal space: a quick warm-up from earlier weeks, explain-it-back cards where you put each key concept in your own words and compare with the reading, and a question ladder that works the week's guiding questions from recall to application. Nothing is recorded or graded; your notes stay in your own browser.

Knowledge Check. Every week closes with an optional, never scored self-check. Set A and Set B are multiple choice, this week's ideas plus a short review from earlier weeks; Set C is different, with short scenarios, matching, and a written reflection you compare against a model. After you answer, you can say how sure you were, and the summary shows not just what you got right but where a confident answer was actually wrong, the thing most worth fixing. Nothing is recorded; clear or change any answer and take another set fresh.

- 1 **Time budget**, under the title, roughly how the week's work divides up.
- 2 **Overview & How this week works**, read this first; it tells you what to do and in what order.
- 3 **Purpose & Outcomes**, what you should be able to do by the end. Test yourself against these sentences.
- 4 **Guiding Questions**, carry at least one with you into the readings.
- 5 **Key Concepts**, each explained and cited to that week's reading, so you always know where an idea comes from.
- 6 **Readings**, full citation and a button. Open access, Seneca Library, Read on Blackboard, or Revisit from an earlier week.
- 7 **The Experience**, an interactive chapter sequence embedded on the page. Enter it, make choices, inspect the evidence, and use the Arrow keys to move between chapters.
- 8 **The Activity**, press Start and follow the prompts. Practice, not assessment.
- 9 **Reflect**, a short prompt (one or two sentences) to close the week.
- 10 **You can now**, the week's closing checklist. Tick what you can genuinely do; anything left unticked shows exactly what to revisit. Reset any time.

SOC122 Companion

ORIENT

- How This Site Works
- Home**
- Course Pathways
- Calendar and Due Dates

Personalize your route
The required sources, outcomes, assessments, and grading stay the same.

YOUR PROGRAM

General stream / no program

Changes concept and term examples, the field case, activity purpose, questions, and reflection.

LEARNING EMPHASIS

Two-Eyed Seeing

Hold Western and named Indigenous sources in relation while keeping each whole and attributed.

COMING UP
Open calendar

Live class (September 11): Week 1 live class Course orientation and shared start

Assignment released (September 11): Personal Cartography

WEEKLY JOURNEY Week 1

1 Introduction and

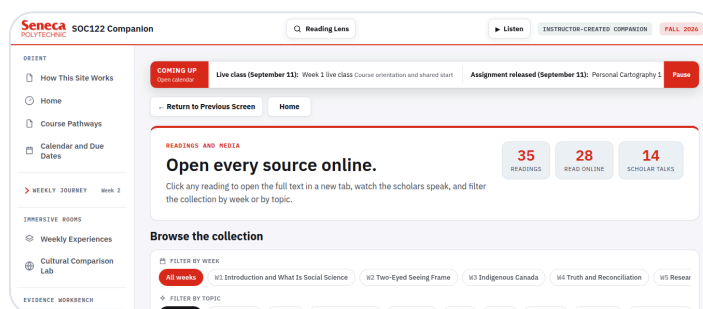
3

A WEEK PAGE · EVERYTHING IN WORKING ORDER, TOP TO BOTTOM

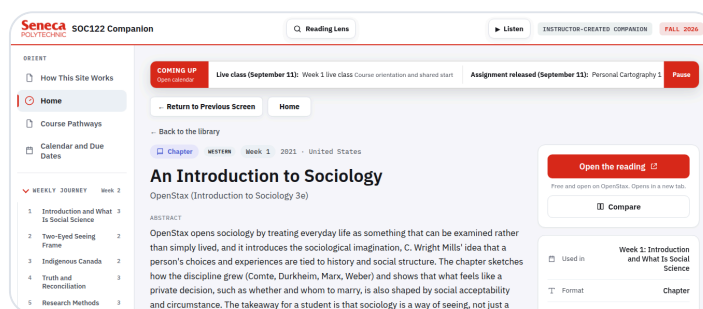
Every reading, as a card

The library holds every course reading: what it is, what it argues, how long it takes, and how to reach it.

- 1 Search any author, title, or idea.
- 2 Filter to one week with the week strip, or browse by format.
- 3 Click a card for the reading's page: core idea, plain-language abstract, level and length, and where the text lives.
- 4 Press the red button to open the reading. A Source page button appears where a separate source or DOI exists.
- 5 Bookmark a reading to your Saved shelf. It stays on this device so you can return before an assessment.



EVERY SOURCE AS A CARD, SEARCHABLE BY WEEK

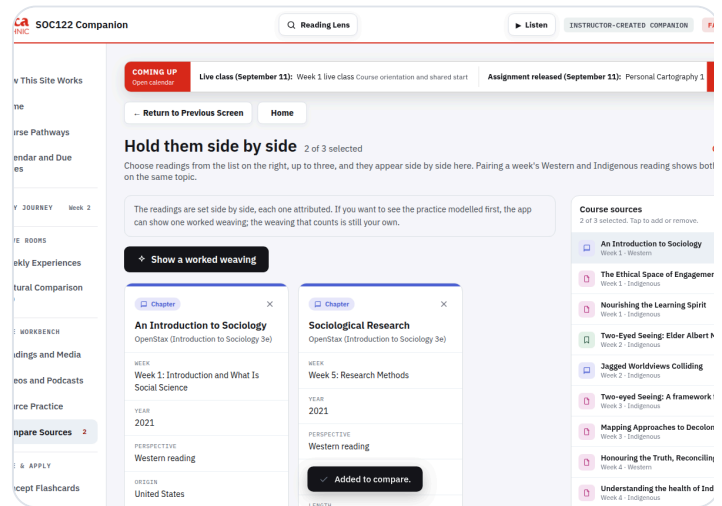


A READING PAGE • CORE IDEA, ABSTRACT, AND THE OPEN BUTTON

COMPARE SOURCES

Hold up to three readings side by side

- 1 Open Compare from the menu, or press Compare on any reading page.
- 2 Pick up to three readings. Each becomes a column: week, year, origin, length, level, and core idea.
- 3 With two or more selected, press **Show a worked weaving**. The site models ONE way of holding the readings together, fully attributed, with both ways of knowing kept whole. It always ends by handing the weaving back to you, because your weaving is the one that counts.
- 4 With three, it takes the pairings one at a time, then asks what only appears when all three are on the table.
- 5 Remove a reading with the × on its column, or Clear all to start over.



THE SITE MODELS THE PRACTICE, THEN HANDS IT BACK TO YOU

SOURCE PRACTICE

Turn any reading into practice

Choose a reading, choose a lens, and answer. Every answer comes back with a short explanation grounded in the reading itself, so a wrong answer still teaches you something specific.

LENS 01

Thematic

What it is about.

LENS 02

Argument

What it claims, and why.

LENS 03

Context

Where it sits in the field and the course.

Never defined out of thin air

- Browse by week (including the closing weeks) or search any term.
- Every definition carries a citation to that week's assigned reading.
- The *Scholars this week* strip introduces the people behind the readings. Click a name to jump to their reading.

Practice, never scored

- Pick a week, or take all weeks together.
- Flip the cards: term on the front, definition and citation on the back.
- Run the short quizzes; each question explains its answer. Nothing is recorded, it exists so you know what to reread before it matters.



Weekly Experiences hub. Every week's experience also lives in one place. Open it from the menu and choose a week to re-enter it without hunting.

ETUAPTMUMK

Two-Eyed Seeing on the site

This course is framed by Etuaptmumk, Two-Eyed Seeing, Mi'kmaw Elder Albert Marshall's principle of seeing with the strengths of Indigenous ways of knowing in one eye and Western ways of knowing in the other, both kept whole. Every reading on the site is labelled with its perspective. Neither is ranked above the other, and the site never blends them into one voice.

Indigenous-scholar reading

Kept whole, in its own voice.

Western reading

Kept whole, in its own voice.

See with both eyes

- 1 Each content week's studio sets the week's two source frames side by side, each attributed.
- 2 Work the prompts: what does each eye let you see that the other cannot?
- 3 Press **Save my work to the Personal Cartography** to download your responses as a Word document you can keep building on all term.

Return to the globe

The Course Synthesis room uses a globe to bring your selected contexts, weekly questions, program route, and learning emphasis back into one evidence trail. It asks what can travel across contexts, what must remain specific, and what responsibility follows from the comparison.

The globe is a synthesis tool, not a claim that the world is one culture. Keep every source attached to its own people, place, purpose, method, and limits.

Browse it however you think

By week

Everything, week by week.

Tiles

The whole library as a wall you can scan.

Index

The alphabetical list.

Reading Lens and other study supports

The **Reading Lens** button at the top of every page opens reading supports that apply across the whole site: text size from 75 to 175 percent, comfortable spacing, a high-legibility font, nine page tints (including a blue light filter that warms the whole screen), a reading ruler that follows your pointer (choose its width, pin it in place, and drag it by hand), a large-print magnifier docked at the bottom of the screen, and read-aloud in your choice of the voices on your own device; a Listen button also sits at the top of every page. Inside an experience, use the separate **A minus**, **A plus**, and **Reset** controls to set experience text from 100 to 200 percent. Dense chapters scroll vertically at readable size instead of shrinking their text. Your choices save only in your browser, stay on until you change them, and a Reset all supports button returns everything to default.

Your saved work. Notes and check answers save automatically in this browser on this device and are never submitted. They will be here when you come back in the same browser. To keep a permanent copy anywhere, use **Generate Your Weekly Notes** at the end of any week. On a shared or lab computer, the How This Site Works page has a one-click **Clear my saved work** control.

Week pages start folded. Each week opens as a clean map of headings. Press the button beside any heading to open just that section, up to two sections stay open at once (opening a third folds the earliest), and you can fold any section back down when you finish it. Sections fold again when you leave the week, so every visit starts from the clean map, and jumping to a section from the side list opens it for you.

Your study compass. The home page opens with a small panel that reads only what you have already done on this device (weeks opened, checks tried, reflections written) and offers up to three next steps. It uses a few fixed rules, not AI, and nothing about you leaves your browser. You can add your first name so the site greets you; the name stays in this browser only, is never sent anywhere, and Clear my saved work removes it along with everything else.

Reading Rescue. Inside each week's Readings section, Reading Rescue is the shortest honest path back in if you fall behind: one anchor reading, one concept to carry, and one evidence question. It is a way back into the readings, never a replacement for them.

If something breaks. Weekly Experiences now open inside the site with the menu still beside you, and every image and 3D model can be enlarged. If a video will not load or anything looks wrong, the How This Site Works page has a Report a problem button that emails the instructor with the page details filled in. If the site is ever unavailable, everything required for the course is also on Blackboard.

Privacy. Nothing on this site contacts an external service until you choose to load or play a video; when you do, YouTube's privacy-enhanced player applies its own practices inside its frame.

Make a small, realistic start plan

Open **Starting Your Assignment**, then choose **Assignment Start Lab**. Choose the assignment and a realistic work-block length, then add as much personal context as helps: your preferred name, program or field, due date, next work session, exact sticking point, and work already completed.

What it creates. Fixed course rules combine your answers into a personal starting point, course-specific next actions, a success target for the next work session, useful questions, and the right human support routes. The plan also explains why each pathway was selected. No AI is used.

What stays private. Your name, context, answers, and plan stay in this browser on this device. Nothing is uploaded, submitted, graded, or sent to the instructor. Print or save the plan as a PDF, or copy it as text.

A PRIVATE PLAN · READY TO PRINT OR SAVE AS PDF

Blackboard remains official. Always return there for the complete brief, rubric, due date, submission link, and recorded grade. The lab helps you begin; it does not write the assignment or replace the instructor's requirements.

GOOD HABITS FOR THE TERM

A rhythm that works

STEP 1

Open the week page early and read the overview.

STEP 2

Do the readings with one guiding question in hand.

STEP 3

Enter the experience and follow its chapters. Increase the text size if you need it and scroll within a dense chapter.

STEP 4

Do the activity.

STEP 5

Tick the You can now checklist honestly.

Before each assessment, use **Compare Sources** on the readings you plan to write about, then use the week's Concept Flashcards, Study Guide, and Knowledge Check to find the concepts or evidence limits that need another look.

PRACTICAL NOTES

Good to know

- Works on phones, tablets, and laptops, and is designed for keyboard navigation.
- Clearing browser data clears them, and they do not follow you between devices.
- Your saved shelf, notes, and check answers live only in your own browser, on your own device.
- If the site looks stale after an announced update, refresh the page once.

THE ONE RULE THAT MATTERS

When in doubt, Blackboard wins.

SOC122 companion website. Blackboard remains the official course platform for submissions, grades, announcements, discussions, and course records.

QUICK REFERENCE

Where to go for what

Start this week's work	Home ▶ click the week ▶ work top to bottom
Find a reading fast	Readings and Media ▶ search or week strip
See how readings connect	Compare Sources ▶ pick up to three
Test yourself on a reading	Source Practice ▶ pick a lens
Look up a term	Glossary ▶ search
Drill before an assessment	Concept Flashcards and Knowledge Checks ▶ pick the weeks
Re-enter the week's experience	Weekly Experiences ▶ pick the week
Submit anything / check grades	Blackboard, always